

Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders With Flow Designer

1. 🧠 Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

- **Problem Identification:** The current IT procurement process for standard laptops is highly manual. Delays happen frequently between the approval of a Service Request and the actual hands-on configuration by the hardware team due to communication gaps and manual task creation.
- **Proposed Solution:** Leverage **ServiceNow Flow Designer** to completely automate the post-approval lifecycle. By replacing manual handoffs with an automated system trigger, a Catalog Task will instantly alert the Hardware team the moment a request is approved.

Key Ideas Explored:

- Option A: Creating a traditional Workflow via Workflow Editor (Deprecated/Legacy approach).
- Option B: Using Business Rules to generate tasks (Harder to maintain, requires coding).
- Option C: Using **Flow Designer** with a Service Catalog trigger (Best practice, low-code, highly scalable).

Final Choice Justification: Flow Designer was chosen because it provides a visual representation of the business logic, reduces time-to-market, and aligns with ServiceNow's mIn modern corporate environments, delays in IT onboarding and hardware provisioning directly impact employee productivity. The legacy IT procurement setup at our organization relied heavily on manual hand-offs. When a request for a standard asset (like a laptop) was submitted, procurement desk agents had to manually review the item, manually spawn sub-tasks, and explicitly assign them to the fulfillment teams.

1.2 Identified Process Bottlenecks

- **Delayed Configurations:** Laptops sit in storage post-delivery because the configuration request wasn't sent to the hardware queue on time.
- **Human Oversight:** High ticket volumes cause service desk agents to miss manual task creation entirely.
- **Lack of Standardized Descriptions:** Manual tasks often lack consistent instructions, leading to confusion regarding specific setup requirements.

- **Process Opaque to End-Users:** Lack of immediate automated state updates forces users to continuously follow up via email or phone.

1.3 Brainstormed Technical Solutions (ServiceNow Solutions Evaluated)

- **Option A: Traditional Workflow Editor (Legacy)**
 - Pros: Proven legacy tech stack.
 - Cons: Requires complex graphical scripting, harder to maintain, and is being actively deprecated by ServiceNow in favor of modern tools.

Option B: Core Business Rules via JavaScript (`current.insert()`)

- Pros: Fast platform execution.
- Cons: Hardcodes configuration variables; requires extensive JavaScript knowledge; dynamic adjustments require code modification.

Option C: Flow Designer Automation (Selected Solution)

- Pros: Native low-code/no-code interface, easier logical readability, built-in data pills for dragging platform records, highly modular, and easily updated by business process admins.